Daniel Dobromilsky & Associates

Landscape Architecture - Planning - Tree Expert

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MEMORANDUM

DATE: January 30, 2017

TO: **John M. West, PE**
Land Use Engineer, Municipality of Princeton

FROM: **Dan Dobromilsky**, P.L.A., P.P., C.T.E.

RE: **86 SPRUCE STREET, LLC -- Minor Site Plan w/ Variances**
Landscape Architectural Plan Review
86 Spruce St. (B-33.03, L-62&63) Z1616-420 713PR

The plans submitted for this application (dated, last revised 1/11/17) have been analyzed and a site visit has been conducted. The following comments are offered regarding the proposed landscape architectural development, relative to municipal codes and industry standards, for consideration as this application is reviewed:

1. The plans depict the location of 26 existing trees that are either on this property or straddle the property line. These trees have been tagged and survey numbers are indicated on the plans, however a schedule describing the species, size and condition of the trees is not provided. At least one of the existing trees is dead, and several more exhibit signs of significant decline. Also, it would appear that some of the existing trees are exotic invasive species (e.g. Norway Maple) that could present environmental harm. The declining trees present concerns for safety and could conflict (existing roots and shading) with some of the proposed landscape plantings. It is recommended that the existing trees should be evaluated by an Arborist or Tree Expert to determine if some of the existing trees should be removed to address the above noted concerns.

   Additionally, it would appear that one additional evergreen tree is present in the front yard of this property in close proximity to the proposed driveway and apron expansion. One or more trees in this location may present conflict with the proposed construction and/or sight distance for motorist and pedestrians. The trees in this location should be more carefully examined relative to these concerns.

2. Evergreen trees (48- *Thuja plicata*, Green Giant Arborvitae) planted at 6' height and a spacing of 6' on center are proposed around the entire perimeter of the parking lot, as a buffer from the adjacent residential property yards. This planting and plant selection is an appropriate design to address code requirements to mitigate nuisance factors created by the presence of the parking lot relative to the adjacent yards.

   There are some overgrown, deciduous shrubs located in the southwest corner of the property that will need to be removed to implement this planting. The plans do not specify the removal of these shrubs.

3. Six understory trees (*Cornus florida*, Dogwood) are proposed to be planted near the drive and in the rear yard setback of this property. The purpose of the planting in the rear yard is not evident. These trees will be located in a narrow strip of lawn between existing and proposed rows of Arborvitae trees, which will grow taller than the dogwood trees. A tree selection (different species or cultivar) that grows a bit taller might be more appropriate near the drive to avoid future conflict with vehicles on the drive with low and wide branches from the Dogwood trees.

4. It was observed that some time ago a street tree was likely present along the Spruce Street frontage of this property. The sidewalk bows in shape, but there are no above ground signs of a remnant tree stump. It would seem desirable to plant a new street tree in this location, if the previous stump has decomposed to facilitate replanting.

Additional commentary shall be offered relative to specific requests or questions and in response to testimony or the submission of additional information. If you have any questions please do not hesitate to contact our office.

C: D. Bridger